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PHOTOS BY ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

A man prayed during afternoon Mass at the Basilica of Our Lady of Perpetual Help in Boston on Wednesday.

A NEW ROCK OF THE CHURCH

As Catholics mourn pope, immigrants invigorate Boston's parishes

By Brian MacQuarrie and Nathan Metcalf
GLOBE STAFF AND GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

When Dolores Rodriguez arrived in East Boston from El Salvador, she didn't speak English or know anyone in the city.

Rodriguez, 48, was far from her family, grieving the distance, and struggling to build a life in her new country. Everything changed when she walked through the doors of Most Holy Redeemer Church, she said.

"That was the main thing," Rodriguez said. "Everybody is welcome right there — Latin people, American people. You feel at home."

Today, 27 years later, she has deep roots in the Catholic Church. Following the sexual-abuse crisis that badly damaged the Boston Archdiocese, a surge of committed, immigrant parishioners such as Rodriguez has given the area's Catholic Church hope for the future.

Such interest has heartened the archdiocese at a time when fewer adults in Greater Boston identify as Catholic: 24 percent last year, down from 29 percent in 2014, according to the Pew Research Center.



CATHOLICS, Page A7

The basilica, founded in 1870, is also known as Mission Church.

As N.H. maternity units close, care can be hard to get to

Some worry, 'Am I going to give birth on the side of the road?'

By Amanda Gokee
GLOBE STAFF

CONCORD, N.H. — Jessie Ingerson was feeding her goats and sheep at her home in Jefferson when her water broke in March 2023.

She knew it was time to head to the hospital, a 42-mile trip that often took 90 minutes over mountain roads that could become impassable in bad weather.

As her husband drove up Gorham Hill, Ingerson could feel the pressure mounting with the elevation, her contractions growing more

painful.

"That definitely added more anxiety," Ingerson said.

Since 2002, 11 of the 26 labor and delivery units in the state have closed, creating what the state has deemed "maternity deserts" in parts of rural New Hampshire. To help fill the gaps, the state is training emergency first responders who say they are increasingly coming to the aid of women in labor.

"This is a service that people desperately need, that people will literally die if they don't have," said Daisy

J. Goodman, a nurse-midwife at Dartmouth Health who works with the North Country Maternity Network, a group that seeks to create and support maternal health infrastructure in northern New Hampshire.

Many of the hospitals that have closed their labor and delivery units faced financial pressure to do so, according to the latest report from the New Hampshire Department of Health and Human Services. The units can be expensive to maintain, requiring costly malpractice insur-

ance, 24-hour staffing, and specialists, such as someone who can provide a C-section.

The units that closed had fewer births and more mothers who were insured by Medicaid, which traditionally doesn't reimburse as well as private insurance, Goodman said.

New London Hospital had been operating at a loss for three years when it closed its birthing unit as a way to control costs, a hospital spokesperson told the Concord Monitor in 2002. In 2008, when Weeks Memorial Hospital in Lancaster closed its birthing unit, it

LABOR, Page A10

Signs of spring: flowers, pollen, stripers

Migration map helps fishing fans count down to arrival day



STAN GROSSFELD/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

Fishermen, such as these on the Cape Cod Canal in 2020, know it's spring when the striped bass arrive.

By Billy Baker
GLOBE STAFF

When the first Striper Migration Map appears on a Friday in late March each year, it starts a delirium in a certain segment of the population. We'll call them "striped bass enthusiasts," because at least a few of them are not yet full-blown obsessives.

Mind you, it's not a small group. More than 2 million people viewed the first map this year, when it was published March 28 on the website and social media feeds of Cape Cod-based On the Water magazine. And most will continue to follow the map as it is updated each Friday, tracking one of the staggering stories of the natural world in the Northeast — the long annual swim made by millions and millions of striped bass from the Outer Banks and Chesapeake Bay to spend their summer in New England.

It's just a map. And all it shows is the location of one type of fish. But for the right set of eyes, it is the unofficial beginning of so much more.

STRIPERS, Page A10

Foreign students' status is restored

But reversal does not allay visa fears among academics

By Danny McDonald, Steven Porter, and Omar Mohammed

GLOBE STAFF

The Trump administration suddenly restored the legal status of thousands of international students Friday, bringing at least a temporary reprieve on an issue that has rattled the international community at public and private universities.

The change, disclosed during a court hearing in Washington state, follows a flurry of lawsuits filed by students in federal courts challenging the revocation of their status, which was often done without notice or explanation.

In a court filing, the Trump administration said it is developing a new system for reviewing the legal status of international students and academics, and, in the interim, would restore those who had been removed from the Student and Exchange Visitor Information System. SEVIS, as it's known, is the central database the federal government uses to track international students and is maintained by US Immigration and Customs Enforcement, or ICE.

Tricia McLaughlin, an assistant Homeland Security secretary, said ICE had not reversed course on any visa revocations but did "restore SEVIS access for people who had not had their visa revoked."

Christina DiIorio Sterling, a spokesperson for the US attorney's office in Massachusetts, said Friday.

STUDENTS, Page A7

FBI arrests judge, saying she shielded man at court

By Devlin Barrett

NEW YORK TIMES

FBI agents arrested a Milwaukee County judge on Friday on charges of obstructing immigration agents, saying she steered an immigrant through a side door in her courtroom while the agents waited to arrest him in a public hallway.

The decision to charge a sitting state court judge is a major escalation in the Trump administration's battle with local authorities over deportations. The administration has demanded, under threat of investigation or prosecution, that local officials not impede federal efforts to deport millions of immigrants in the country illegally. The arrest sent a message that the administration intends to take a harder line with those that do.

The arrest of Judge Hannah C. Dugan comes after months of rising tensions between the Trump administration and the judiciary. President Trump and his top advisers have repeatedly assailed "local judges" for halting or questioning actions taken by the administration, particularly when it comes to immigration cases.

Trump's drive to round up and deport large numbers of migrants has also led to other disputes with federal judges, especially over his use of the Alien Enemies Act to send Venezuelans out of the country.

JUDGE, Page A6

The Celtics came up short in the final minute and dropped Game 3 to Orlando, 95-93. Boston still leads the series, 2-1. **C1.**

George Santos, the former Republican member of Congress known for his fabrications and schemes, was sentenced to 87 months in federal prison. **A2.**

Dozens of professors at Wellesley College returned to the classroom, ending a weeks-long strike without their first contract. **D1.**

Antisemitic incidents continued to occur at record numbers in New England last year, according to a report from the ADL. **B1.**



Spring a leak

Saturday: Rainy, stormy. High: 61-66. Low: 46-51.
Sunday: Windy, some sun. Comics and Weather, **D4-5.** Obituaries, **C10.**

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